



This later depiction of the Battle of Agincourt shows cavalry engaged in conflict; around 10,000 French troops were killed or captured.



This illustration from the Chronicle of Ulrich von Richental shows the papal electors taking their leave from Emperor Sigismund at the Council of Constance.

the forces of the Teutonic Knights who were around 11,000 strong. The Order was crushed, but Jagiello was unable to keep the powerful Polish nobles in order and thus could not press home his advantage. The **Peace of Thorn**, concluded the following year, failed to secure Polish access to the Baltic and enabled the Teutonic Knights to regain some of their advantage.

Andrei Rublev (c. 1370–1430) was a Russian monk and painter, based at the St. Sergius monastery of the Holy Trinity in Moscow. He worked during a period of monastic revival in Russia, when

the Eastern Orthodox Church offered comfort in the face of internecine war and the hated **Mongol Yoke**—the tribute and service exacted by the Golden Horde. Though inspired by the great icon painter Theophanes the Greek, Rublev was celebrated for pioneering a new, more serene and symmetrical style.



The Holy Trinity
This detail from Andrei Rublev's greatest icon, painted around 1410, shows the three angels who visited Abraham. Each angel represents a different aspect of the Trinity.

IN 1413, HENRY IV OF ENGLAND DIED and his son, Henry V (1386–1422), came to the throne. In 1415, Henry concluded an alliance with Burgundy and reasserted the **English claim to the French crown** as a pretext for renewing the **Hundred Years' War** (see panel, right). In October, Henry inflicted a terrible defeat on a far superior French force at **Agincourt**, taking the Duke of Orleans prisoner, and going on to conquer Normandy.

“...THE LIVING
FELL ON TOP OF
THE DEAD, AND
OTHERS FALLING
ON TOP OF THE
LIVING WERE
KILLED AS WELL.”

From *Gesta Henrici Quinti*, c. 1416

During **Chinese explorer Zheng He's** fourth and greatest expedition in 1413, he visited Calicut in India, and reached Hormuz on the Persian Gulf, sending ships to explore down the African coast as far as Malindi in Kenya. The fleet included 63 ships of up to 260 ft (80 m) long.

In 1414, anti-pope **John XXIII**—one of three men claiming to be pope—was expelled from Rome by King Ladislas of Naples. John sought refuge with the emperor, **Sigismund**, who forced him to

convene a general council—the **Council of Constance**—to resolve the split in the Catholic Church known as the **Great Schism** (see 1373–80). In 1415, the Council deposed the existing claimants, and condemned the Bohemian priest, religious reformer, and philosopher **Jan Huss**, who was executed the same year.



THE HUNDRED YEARS' WAR

The series of conflicts from 1337 to 1453, later known as the Hundred Years' War, was triggered by a combination of factors: tensions over the status of the duchy of Guienne, which belonged to the kings of England but owed sovereignty to the French crown; English claims to that crown, based on descent from the Capetians; anxieties of influence on both sides; and the need of English kings to use foreign adventures to shore up support at home. There should have been little contest between France, the most powerful nation in Europe, and smaller, poorer England, but the English used new tactics and weapons, especially the longbow, to devastating effect. The war drained resources on both sides, but also forged a new degree of national identity for both countries.

[1361–1419], sparked a **Hussite uprising** in Bohemia. This combined a religious tussle between the papacy and antipapists, with a nationalist struggle between Czechs (Bohemians and Moravians) and Germans. The Hussites, made up of moderate (Utraquist) and extreme (Taborite) factions, united to face a crusading alliance led by Wenceslaus' brother, the emperor Sigismund. The Hussites defeated the alliance outside Prague.

In 1411, **peace** was concluded between **Portugal and Castile** (see 1381–85). Portugal now began to look outward, winning a foothold on the north coast of Africa at Ceuta in 1415. Explorer **Henry the Navigator** (1394–1460) distinguished himself in the expedition; his visit to Africa sparked an interest in exploration, and he may have set up the first school of navigation in Europe at Sagres, in Portugal (see 1434).

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THE NUMBER
OF SESSIONS
HELD AT THE
42-MONTH-
LONG COUNCIL
OF CONSTANCE

1410 Polish-Lithuanian forces defeat Teutonic Knights at **Battle of Tannenberg**

1410 Death of Kanajéji, king of Kano, present-day Nigeria

1410 Anti-pope John XIII makes **Medici Bank** in Florence the papal bank

1411 **Peace of Thorn** ends conflict between Knights and Polish-Lithuanian forces

1413 Battle of Jamurtu in Serbia

1413 Henry IV of England dies (b. 1366)

1414 Khizr Khan establishes **Sayyid** dynasty in Delhi

1413 Accession of Henry V of England

1413 Fourth and greatest expedition of Zheng He

1415 Portugal conquers **Ceuta** in Africa

1415 Battle of Agincourt fought between French and English

1416 Nobleman Amadeus VII named duke of Savoy; annexes Piedmont, Italy

1417 Council of Constance ends **Great Schism**

1419 Henry the Navigator (1394–1460) possibly sets up school of navigation in Portugal

1417 Ming emperor Yongle (1360–1424) fixes **Confucian canon**, reinstitutes civil service exam system

1420 **Hussite Wars**: Hussites under Jan Žižka defeat anti-Hussite crusade